

RETAIL SALES PERFORMANCE

Business Insights Report

January 2022 – December 2024

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About This Report

This report presents a summary of retail sales performance across three years of transaction data, covering the period January 2022 to December 2024. It draws on 76,226 transactions recorded across seven product categories and eight South African provinces.

The goal of this report is to highlight where the business is performing well, where opportunities exist, and to surface any patterns worth attention – presented clearly and without technical jargon.

Performance at a glance

The following headline numbers summarize the full three–year dataset:

R447.6M Total Revenue Jan 2022 – Dec 2024	76,226 Transactions All order statuses	R5,968 Avg Order Value Per transaction	75% Completion Rate Orders fulfilled
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10% Return Rate Orders returned	Electronics Top Category 52% of revenue	Eastern Cape Top Region R85.1M revenue	3.0 / 5 Avg Rating Across all products
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Revenue by Product Category

Over all three years, Electronics dominates total revenue by a wide margin – generating over half of all sales value despite customers purchasing similar frequencies across all categories. This tells us that Electronics customers are buying higher–value items, not buying more often.

Category	Revenue	Transactions	Revenue Share
Electronics	R234,753,605	10,836	52.4%
Home & Garden	R104,819,720	10,788	23.4%
Sports	R51,263,845	10,980	11.5%
Clothing	R23,345,205	10,888	5.2%
Health & Beauty	R15,512,271	10,964	3.5%
Toys	R13,960,024	10,865	3.1%
Food & Beverage	R3,979,893	10,905	0.9%

 What this means

All seven categories attract a very similar number of customers. The gap in revenue is driven by price points, not demand. Electronics and Home & Garden together account for over 75% of total revenue – these two categories are the commercial backbone of the business.

 Something to watch

Food & Beverage generates just 0.9% of total revenue despite a comparable number of transactions (10,905). This suggests very low average transaction values – worth reviewing pricing and basket size strategy in this category.

Regional Performance

The business operates across all eight South African provinces. Eastern Cape leads on total revenue, closely followed by Gauteng. The remaining six provinces perform at a broadly similar level, each generating between R41M and R43.6M over the three–year period.

	Province	Revenue (3yr)	Transactions	Rank
	Eastern Cape	R85,073,610	14,693	1st
	Gauteng	R84,160,456	14,345	2nd
	Northern Cape	R43,595,559	7,273	3rd
	KwaZulu–Natal	R43,004,470	7,338	4th
	Mpumalanga	R42,861,847	7,164	5th
	Western Cape	R42,795,211	7,240	6th
	Limpopo	R42,275,571	7,252	7th
	Free State	R41,298,851	7,212	8th

What this means

Eastern Cape and Gauteng are significantly ahead, each generating roughly double the revenue of any other province. This likely reflects larger population centers and higher purchasing power. The six remaining provinces are remarkably close to each other in performance, suggesting consistent market penetration but limited differentiation.

How Customers Are Paying

The business accepts five payment methods. Revenue is distributed very evenly across Cash, EFT, Mobile Pay, Credit Card, and Debit Card – with no single method dominating customer preference.

Payment Method	Revenue	Transactions	Revenue Share
Cash	R82,959,661	14,227	18.5%
EFT	R82,449,932	14,111	18.4%
Mobile Pay	R81,325,492	13,738	18.2%
Credit Card	R81,108,578	14,157	18.1%
Debit Card	R81,010,338	13,686	18.1%

 What this means

The near–equal split across all payment methods is unusual and suggests either a very broad customer demographic or that the recording of payment method is not always accurate. In real–world retail, one or two methods typically lead. This is a data point worth exploring further with operational teams.

Order Outcomes

Of the 76,226 transactions recorded, three out of four were successfully completed. However, a 10% return rate and a meaningful number of pending and cancelled orders represent areas of potential revenue recovery.

Order Status	Transactions	Revenue	Share
Completed	57,163	R336,580,162	75.0%
Returned	7,655	R44,377,194	10.0%
Pending	7,564	R43,738,551	9.9%
Cancelled	3,844	R22,938,654	5.0%

 Revenue at risk

Returns, pending, and cancelled orders together account for approximately R111M in revenue that is either lost or unconfirmed. Even recovering a fraction of pending orders through better follow-up processes could have a meaningful impact on confirmed revenue.

Revenue Trends Over Time

Monthly revenue has remained remarkably stable across all three years, consistently landing between R10.9M and R13.3M per month. There are no dramatic peaks or troughs, and no clear seasonal pattern stands out at this level of analysis.

Year	Transactions	Revenue	Monthly Avg
2022	24,420	R153,539,467	R12,795,000
2023	24,338	R152,150,402	R12,679,000
2024	24,407	R154,624,097	R12,885,000

 What this means

Year-on-year revenue is essentially flat, with less than 2% variation between the three years and very consistent transaction volumes (~24,400 per year). This suggests a stable, mature business with consistent demand – but limited growth. The key opportunity is not driving more transactions, but in increasing average order value or reducing order loss (returns and cancellations).

Key Recommendations

Based on the analysis of three years of transaction data, the following actions are recommended for consideration:

1 Reduce the return rate

Returns account for 10% of all transactions and R44.4M in reversed revenue. Investigating the categories, products, or regions with the highest return rates could identify correctable issues – whether in product quality, customer expectations, or delivery.

2 Convert pending orders to completed

Nearly 7,600 orders worth R43.7M are sitting in a Pending status. A follow-up or escalation process for pending orders could recover a portion of this unconfirmed revenue.

3 Grow average order value in lower-revenue categories

Food & Beverage, Toys, and Health & Beauty collectively attract similar customer traffic to Electronics but generate far less revenue. Bundling, upselling, or targeted promotions in these categories could improve their contribution without requiring new customers.

4 Investigate the rating data

Average customer ratings are a uniform 3.0 out of 5 across every category with no variation. This may indicate that the rating collection process needs to be reviewed – genuine customer ratings should show more variability and can be a valuable input for product and service decisions.

About This Analysis

This report was produced using three years of retail transaction data (76,226 records) cleaned and structured using SQL, then visualized using Microsoft Power BI. The analysis covers revenue, transaction volume, order outcomes, regional distribution, and payment preferences.

For questions about the methodology, data sources, or to request deeper analysis on a specific area, please contact the analyst directly.

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